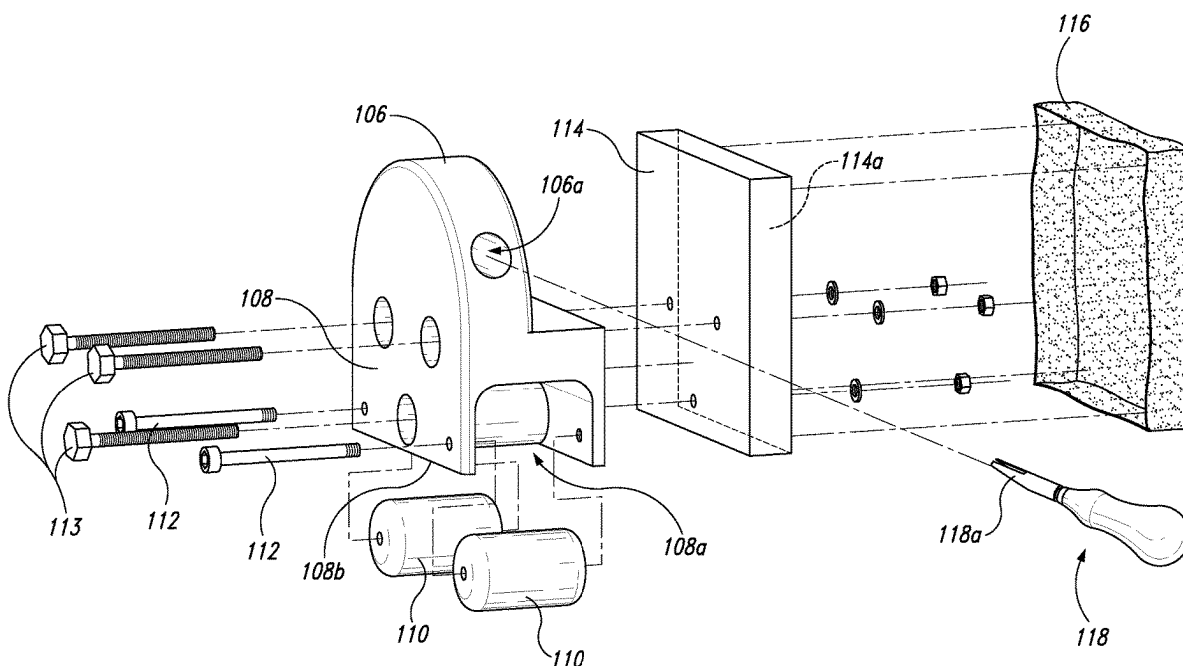




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(19) **United States**(12) **Patent Application Publication**
Low(10) **Pub. No.: US 2025/0270826 A1**(43) **Pub. Date: Aug. 28, 2025**(54) **HANDHELD ROLLABLE TOOL FOR COVE
BASE MOLDING INSTALLATION**(71) Applicant: **David Low**, Centralia, WA (US)(72) Inventor: **David Low**, Centralia, WA (US)(21) Appl. No.: **18/587,737**(22) Filed: **Feb. 26, 2024****Publication Classification**(51) **Int. Cl.**
E04F 21/00 (2006.01)(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC **E04F 21/0069** (2013.01)(57) **ABSTRACT**

The invention is a handheld rollable tool for installing cove base molding at a juncture between a wall and a floor. It has a base with a grippable handle, rotatable wheels attached to the base within a recess, and an outwardly extending baseplate with a flat exterior surface. The outer face of the baseplate can be covered with a detachable felt or textile material to facilitate gliding of the tool over the cove base molding while simultaneously cleaning and/or buffing of the outer surface of the cove base molding during its installation. The handheld rollable tool is designed to nestle against the wall and floor at their juncture and, during use, roll back-and-forth with an applied pressure against the wall.



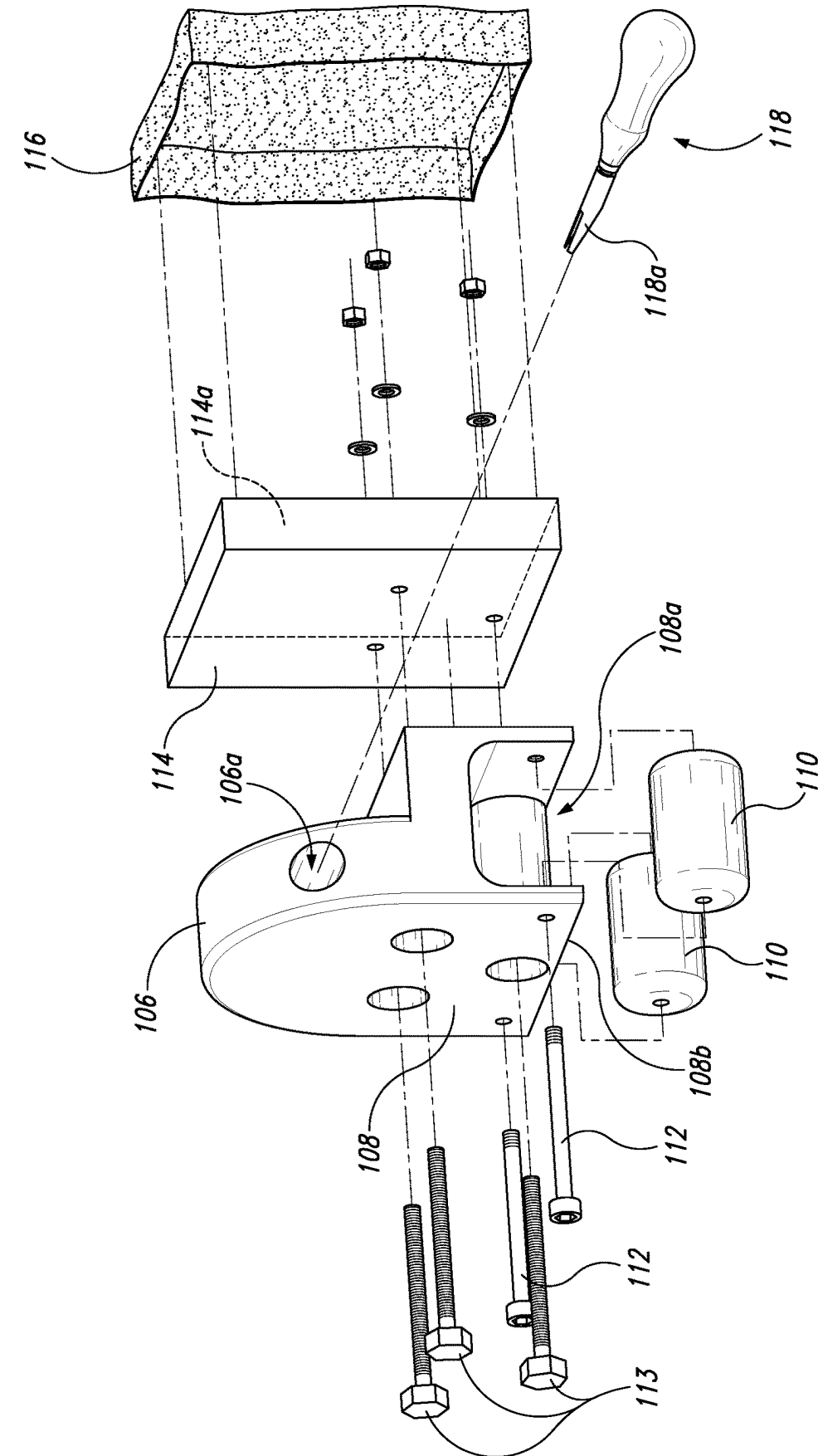
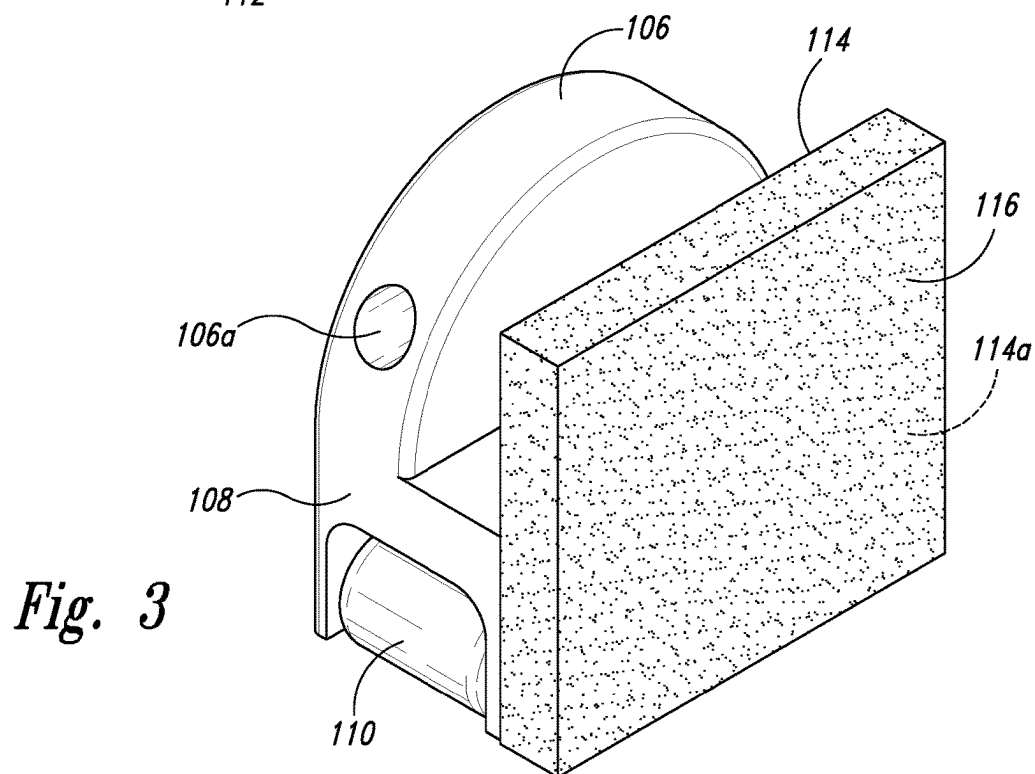
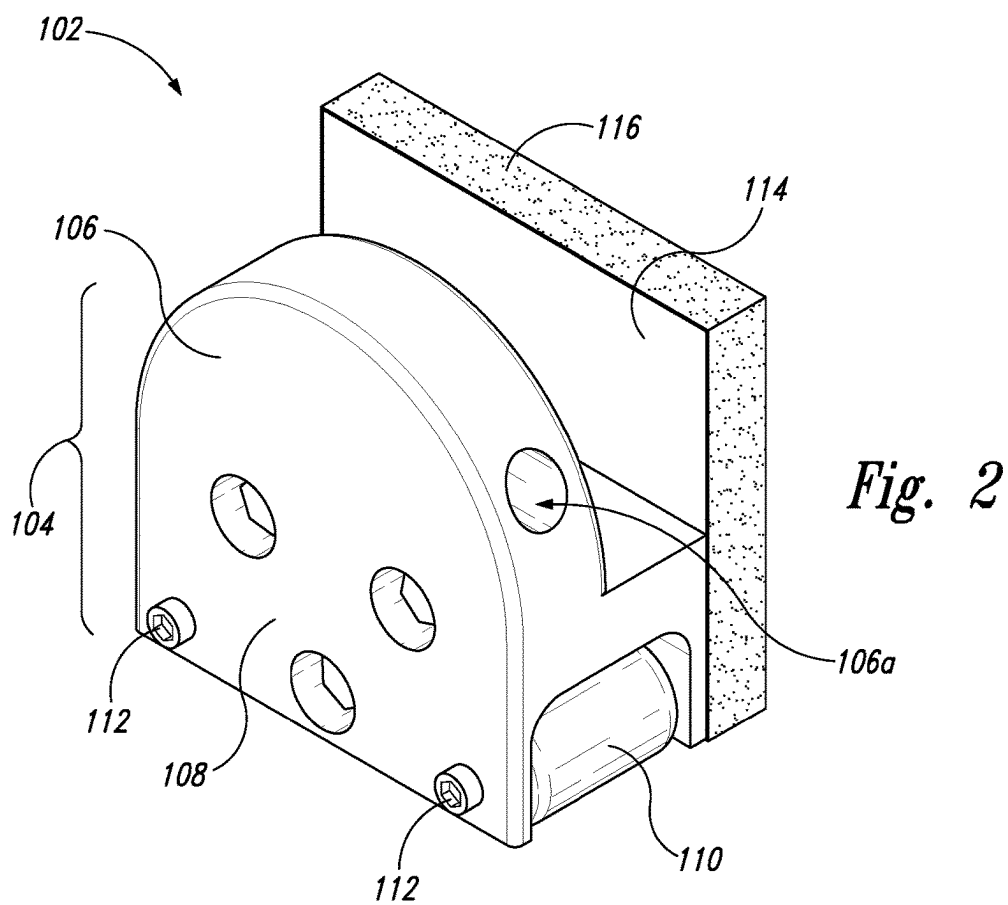
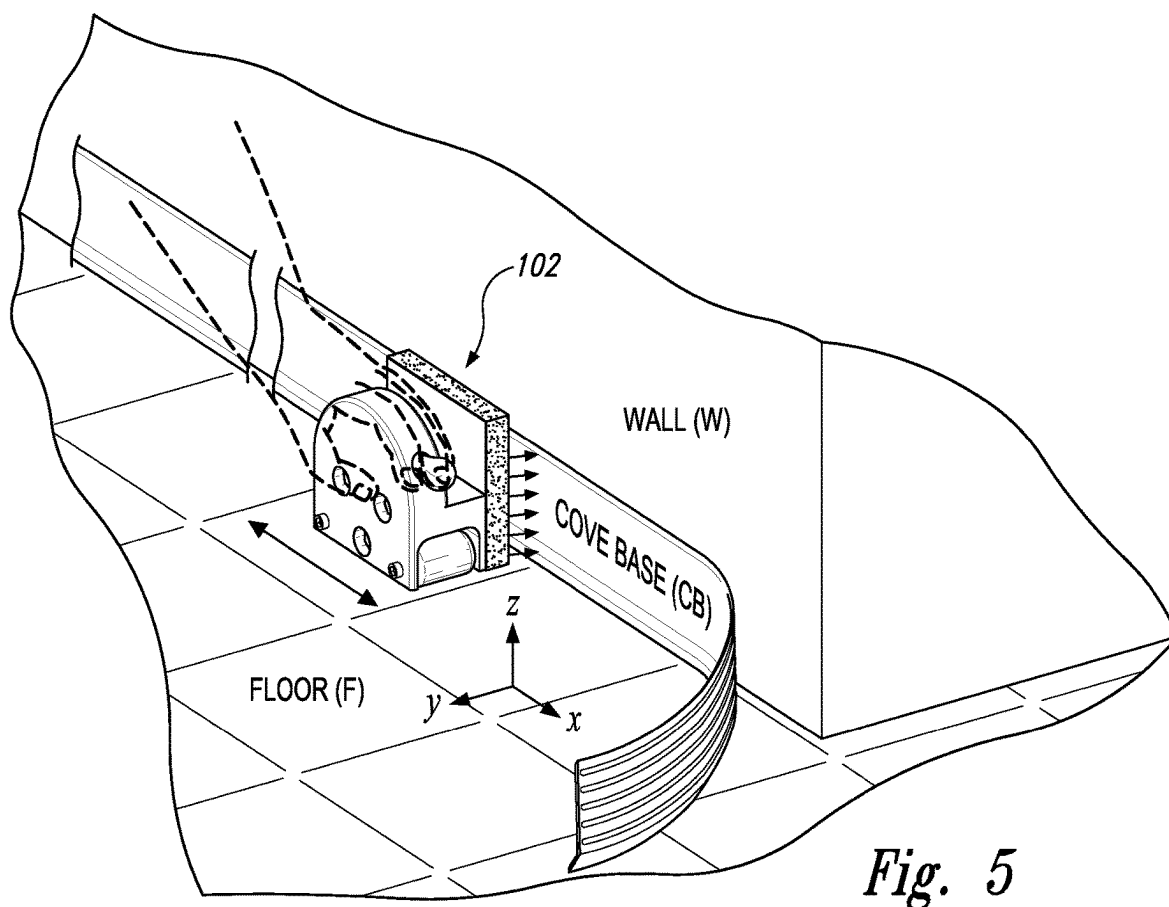
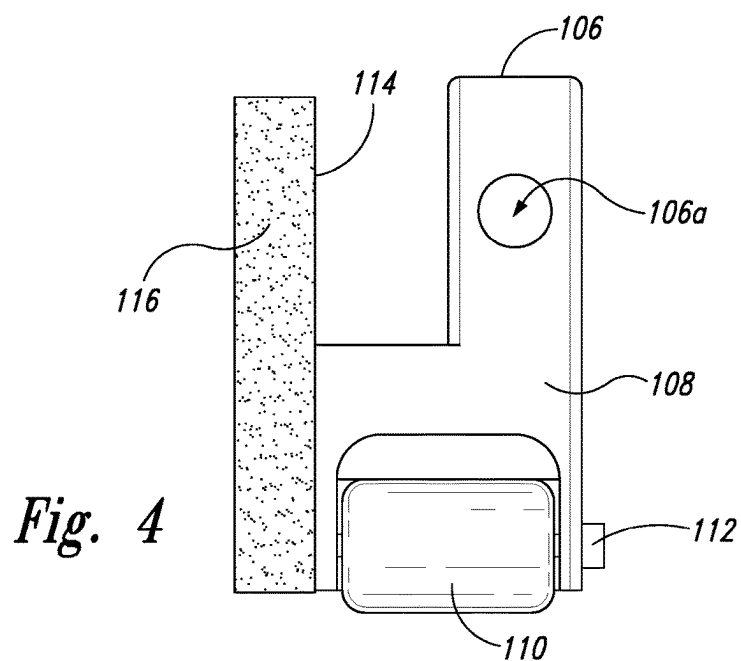


Fig. 1





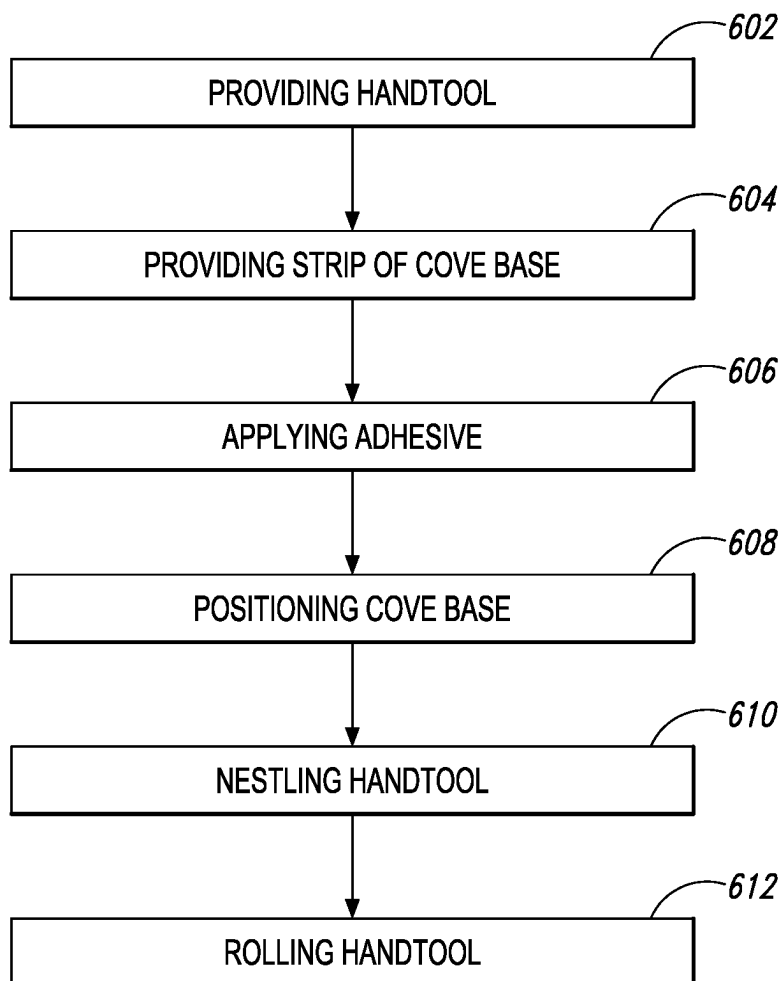


Fig. 6

HANDHELD ROLLABLE TOOL FOR COVE BASE MOLDING INSTALLATION

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0001] The present invention relates generally to interior building construction and, more particularly, to tools for installing cove base molding along a wall at its base.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

[0002] Cove base molding is a type of trim that is used at the base of walls to add a finished look and to protect the wall from damage. Cove base molding is typically made of rubber or vinyl. It is installed at the base of a wall at the juncture between the wall and the floor.

[0003] The installation of cove base molding can be a labor-intensive process that requires precision and skill. Traditionally, the process involves applying an adhesive to the backside of the molding, positioning the molding at the desired location, and then applying pressure (via a roller or by hand) along the length of the molding and against the wall to ensure that the molding adheres properly to the wall. This process can be time-consuming and physically demanding, particularly in large spaces or in areas with complex wall configurations. Furthermore, the process can be messy, with the potential for adhesive to get onto the wall or floor, and/or onto the outside surface of the cove base molding itself. Thus, there is a need for a tool that can facilitate and streamline the process of installing cove base molding.

[0004] Accordingly, and although some progress has been made over the years with respect to tools and methods for installing cove base molding along a wall at its base within a building, there is still a need in the art for new tools and better ways to install cove base molding. The present invention fulfills these needs and provides for further related advantages.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0005] In brief, the present invention is directed to a handheld rollable tool for installing cove base molding at a juncture between a wall (at its base) and a floor. The handheld rollable tool comprises: a base having a top section and a bottom section, wherein the top section is in the form of a grippable handle; rotatable wheels attached to the bottom section of the base within a recess; an outwardly extending baseplate having a substantially flat exterior face (that, when the handheld rollable tool is being used, is parallel to the wall and perpendicular to the floor). In some embodiments, the flat exterior face is optionally covered with a piece of detachable felt (or a felt-like material) and/or a textile material (which material(s) is soft, supple, and enables gliding of the tool along the cove base molding during its installation-while simultaneously cleaning and buffing the outside surface of the cove base molding). In practice, the handheld rollable tool (aka “the wall wiper”) is configured to nestle up against the wall and the floor at their juncture and roll back-and-forth along the wall with an applied pressure (force) against the wall.

[0006] In other embodiments, the present invention is directed to, in combination, the handheld rollable tool and a scoring implement (for selectively scoring the cove base molding during its installation at corners) that is detachable connected to the top section of the base, as well as to

methods for installing cove base molding along a bottom portion of a wall adjacent to a floor.

[0007] These and other aspects of the present invention will become more readily apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art when reference is made to the following detailed description in view of the accompanying drawings.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

[0008] The accompanying drawings illustrate several embodiments and different aspects of the present invention and, together with the detailed description, serve to explain certain principles and operation of the invention. It will be appreciated by those skilled in the art that the particular embodiments illustrated in the drawings and described herein are exemplary, and as such they do not limit the scope of the invention as established by the appended claims.

[0009] In the drawings like reference numerals are used to designate like features throughout the several views of the drawings.

[0010] FIG. 1 is a side front perspective exploded view of a handheld rollable tool for installing a cove base molding along a bottom portion of a wall adjacent to a floor in accordance with an embodiment of the present invention.

[0011] FIG. 2 is an elevated handle side perspective view of the handle-side of the handheld rollable tool illustrated in FIG. 1.

[0012] FIG. 3 is an elevated side baseplate perspective view of the baseplate-side of the handheld rollable tool illustrated in FIG. 1.

[0013] FIG. 4 is a front view of the handheld rollable tool illustrated in FIG. 1.

[0014] FIG. 5 illustrates a handheld rollable tool for installing a cove base CB molding along a bottom portion of a wall W adjacent to a floor F in accordance with an embodiment of the present invention.

[0015] FIG. 6 is a flowchart depicting the different steps of a method for installing a piece of cove base molding along a bottom portion of a wall adjacent to a floor in accordance with an embodiment of the present invention.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

[0016] Referring now to drawings, the present invention is directed to a handheld rollable tool **102** (aka “the wall wiper”) designed for installing a selected cove base molding along a bottom portion of a wall adjacent to a floor. In an exemplary configuration, and as best shown in FIG. 1 through FIG. 4, the handheld rollable tool **102** of the present invention comprises a base **104** having a top section **106** and a bottom section **108** (that may, or may not, be integrally connected to each other). The base **104** is preferably made of a rigid material such as, for example, wood or a hard plastic. As shown, the top section **106** is semi-circular in shape and in the form of a handle configured to be gripped by a user’s hand (shown in dashed-lines in FIG. 5). In other words, the top section **106** of the base **104** is grippable.

[0017] In contrast, the bottom section **108** includes at least a recess **108a** (positioned on a bottom face **108b** as best shown in FIG. 1) that houses a plurality of wheels **110**. As shown, the plurality of wheels **110** may be two (or more) rollers fitted partially within a pair of recesses **108a** and attached to the bottom section **108** of the base **104** by a pair

of corresponding transverse axels **112**. In this configuration, the wheels **110** enable the user to roll the handheld rollable tool **102** back and forth along the wall **W** and the floor **F** (when the handheld rollable tool **102** is being used for installing a selected piece of cove base **CB** molding as shown FIG. **5**). In practice and as best shown in FIG. **5**, the handheld rollable tool **102** is configured to nestle up against the wall **W** and the floor **F** at their juncture and roll back-and-forth along the wall **W** with an applied pressure (force) against the wall **W**.

[0018] As further shown, a baseplate **114** is attached to the bottom section **108** of the base **104** and extends outwardly away from the base **104**. Similar to the base **104**, the attached baseplate **114** is also preferably made of a rigid material such as, for example, wood or a hard plastic. As best shown in FIG. **3**, the baseplate **114** has a substantially flat exterior face **114a** that, when the handheld rollable tool **102** is nestled up against the wall **W** is parallel to the wall **W** and perpendicular to the floor **F** (as best shown in FIG. **5**).

[0019] In order to facilitate the installation of the cove base **CB** molding, the flat exterior face **114a** preferably comprises a pliable material **116** (selected form a felt, a textile material, or a combination thereof) positioned on and covering the flat exterior face **114a**. The selected pliable material **116** should be soft, supple, and enable gliding of the handheld rollable tool **102** along and over the cove base **CB** molding during its installation-while simultaneously cleaning and buffing the outside surface of the cove base **CB** molding.

[0020] In further embodiments, and as best shown in FIG. **1**, the present invention is directed to the handheld rollable tool **102** in combination with a cove base groover tool **118**. As shown, a top section hole **106a** extends into the top section **106** of the base **104**, wherein the hole **116a** is sized and configured to receive a blade section **118a** of a cove base groover tool **118**. As shown, the blade section **118a** of the cove base groover tool **118** is insertable within the hole **106a**.

[0021] In another embodiment, the present invention is directed to a method for installing cove base molding along a bottom portion of a wall adjacent to a floor. As illustrated in the flowchart of FIG. **6**, the method comprises the steps of: providing a handheld rollable tool as described above (block **602**); providing a strip of cove base molding (wherein the strip of cove base molding has a frontside and a backside) (block **604**); applying an adhesive to the backside of the strip of cove base molding (block **606**); positioning the backside of strip of cove base molding with the applied adhesive along the bottom portion of the wall adjacent to the floor (block **608**); nestling the handheld rollable tool against the bottom of the wall and the floor (block **610**); and rolling the handheld rollable tool back and forth along the wall while applying an inward force against the wall so as to thereby adhere the base cove molding to the bottom portion of the wall (block **612**).

[0022] While the present invention has been described in the context of the embodiments illustrated and described herein, the invention may be embodied in other specific ways or in other specific forms without departing from its spirit or essential characteristics. Therefore, the described

embodiments are to be considered in all respects as illustrative and not restrictive. The scope of the invention is, therefore, indicated by the appended claims rather than by the foregoing description, and all changes that come within the meaning and range of equivalency of the claims are to be embraced within their scope.

1. A handheld rollable tool for installing a cove base molding along a bottom portion of a wall adjacent to a floor, comprising:

a base having a top section and a bottom section, wherein the top section is in the form of a handle that is configured to be gripped by a user's hand;

a plurality of rotatable wheels attached to the bottom section of the base, wherein the plurality of rotatable wheels is configured to allow the handheld rollable tool to roll back and forth along the wall and the floor when the handheld rollable tool is being used for installing the cove base molding;

a baseplate attached to the bottom section of the base and extending outwardly away from the base, wherein the baseplate has a substantially flat exterior face that is parallel to the wall and perpendicular to the floor when the handheld rollable tool is nestled up against the wall and the floor.

2. The handheld rollable tool of claim **1**, further comprising a felt, a textile material, or a combination thereof, positioned on and covering the flat exterior face.

3. The handheld rollable tool of claim **1**, further comprising a hole extending into the top section of the top section of the base, wherein the hole is sized and configured to receive a blade section of a cove base groover tool.

4. The handheld rollable tool of claim **3**, further comprising the cove base groover tool, wherein the blade section of the cove base groover tool is inserted within the hole.

5. The handheld rollable tool of claim **4** wherein the plurality of rotatable wheels is two or more rollers fitted partially within a recess positioned on a bottom face of the bottom section of the base.

6. The handheld rollable tool of claim **5** wherein the top section of the base is semi-circular in shape.

7. The handheld rollable tool of claim **4** wherein the base and the baseplate are each made of a rigid material.

8. A method for installing cove base molding along a bottom portion of a wall adjacent to a floor, the method comprising the steps of:

providing a handheld rollable tool according to claim **1**;

providing a strip of cove base molding, wherein the strip of cove base molding has a frontside and a backside;

applying an adhesive to the backside of the strip of cove base molding;

positioning the backside of strip of cove base molding with the applied adhesive along the bottom portion of the wall adjacent to the floor;

nestling the handheld rollable tool against the bottom of the wall and the floor; and

rolling the handheld rollable tool back and forth along the wall while applying an inward force against the wall so as to thereby adhere the base cove molding to the bottom portion of the wall.

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